

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Slow burns, no burns and missing help! *Digit* to the rescue again!

Gone For Good?

Q After I installed Vista, my DVD-ROM drive disappeared. I tried several ways to get it to work, but it doesn't. What can I do?

Ankush Shah

A This happens when an incorrect driver was installed for the DVD-ROM. There are two solutions you can try.

Method 1: In the Control Panel, double-click System. Click on Device Manager in the Hardware tab. Click the drive with the question mark next to it. Click Uninstall in the Action menu and click OK when prompted for confirmation. Click "Scan for hardware changes" on the Action menu. Your drive should get automatically detected. If this does not happen, try Method 2.

Method 2: Open the Registry editor and go to the following key:

HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\System\CurrentControlSet\Control\Class\{4d36e965-e325-11ce-bfc1-08002be10318}

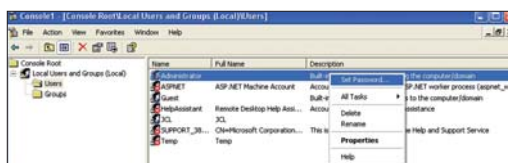
Click Export on the File menu, type "backupkey" in the file name dialog box, and click Save. This will help you revert to the original registry settings for this key, in case you make an error. Now delete the values LowerFilters and UpperFilters in the right-hand pane and restart your PC.

Password Poser

Q I have Windows XP Professional SP2. I need to change the administrator password, but when I log on as Administrator and double-click User Accounts in the Control Panel, the Administrator account does not show up. So how do I change my admin password?

Rasick Patel

A Go to Start > Run, enter "mmc" and hit [Enter]. This will start the Microsoft Management Console. Select File > Add/Remove Snap-in. Now click on Add and select the "Local Users and Groups" snap-in



Change the Administrator password using MMC

from the list, and click Add. Then click on Finish, Close, and OK. Expand Local Users and Groups and select Users. Right-click on Administrator in the right pane and click Set Password. Click Proceed in the dialog box that comes up, and type and confirm the new password. Click OK.

No Option...

Q There is an option "Folder Options" under the Tools menu in Windows Explorer, but it isn't there on my PC. What can I do to bring back the option?

Karmit Singh

A Open the Group Policy Editor by typing in gpedit.msc in the Run dialog box. Navigate to the following location:

User Configuration\Administrative Templates\ Windows Components\Windows Explorer

On the right side, set the "Remove the Folder Options menu item" from the Tools menu to "Not Configured", by double-clicking it and setting the appropriate option.

If you are using Windows XP Home, you will not be able to run the Group Policy Editor, and you will need to use the Registry Editor method, as follows.

Open the Registry Editor. Browse to the following key:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer

Find the NoFolderOptions key and change the value to 0, assuming you have this key. If you don't, just create it. Restart your computer.

Plug-N-Play

Q I installed a certain program that disabled the CD Autoplay feature. How can I re-enable it?

Rajesh Kumar

A Open the Group Policy Editor by typing in gpedit.msc in the Run dialog box. Go to Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > System and double on Turn Autoplay off in the right pane. The default is "Not configured". Set it to Disabled. This only works with Windows XP Professional.

If you have XP Home Edition, open the Registry Editor and navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\CDRom.

Double-click the DWORD "AutoRun" in the right pane and set its value to 1. Close the Registry Editor and restart your computer.

Poof!

Q I use Yahoo! Mail. I received some important mails, then accidentally deleted them. Can I get them back?

VSujan Rai

A There is no way to retrieve mail that has been deleted from the Yahoo! Mail "Deleted Items" folder. Yahoo! clearly states: "Messages in

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!